

card, which offers monitor and TV output. The TV-out stopped working a few days back. The TV screen is blank, but we do get sound. I have Windows 98SE installed. I reinstalled the drivers for the AGP card but that did nothing. All the settings also seem proper. What could the problem be?

Bijay

A First, check the cables: If it is an S-video-to-RCA cable, connect it to your TV and AGP card, remove the monitor connection from the AGP card and power on your PC. If the TV comes alive, then the cable is fine. If you use a RF converter along with this cable, check its frequency; a mismatched frequency could be the problem.

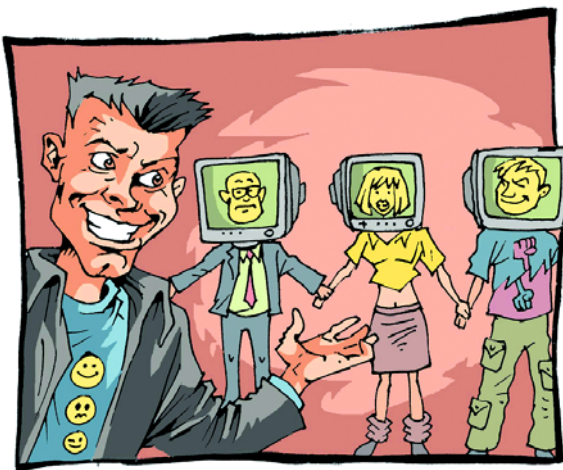
If the display still does not work, then right-click anywhere on your desktop and select Properties. Next, switch to the Settings tab and click on Advanced. Select the tab which has the name of your card, say, GeForce2 440 MX or so, go to the Troubleshooting tab and check the box labelled 'My connected TV does not appear in the list', click OK and then restart your PC. This should resolve your issue.

LAN With Mouse Problems

Q I have a P III 733MHz CPU, a Mercury 810eFST motherboard, running Windows XP and Windows 98 as well.

Recently, I purchased a 5-button Iball black cat optical mouse. At times, the mouse pointer automatically changes its position. The rubber mousepad is blue in colour and coated with plastic. Its sensors do seem fine. Please help.

My college has around 25 computers, running Windows 2000, networked via the LAN. Is there some software that will enable me to chat with my



friends when we are logged on to these systems? If so, where do I download it from?

Mariah Furtado

A The mouse maybe acting up due to a loose USB or PS2 connection. Check whether the connector is firmly inserted in the slot. If the pointer still moves erratically, then the mouse may have a mechanical fault.

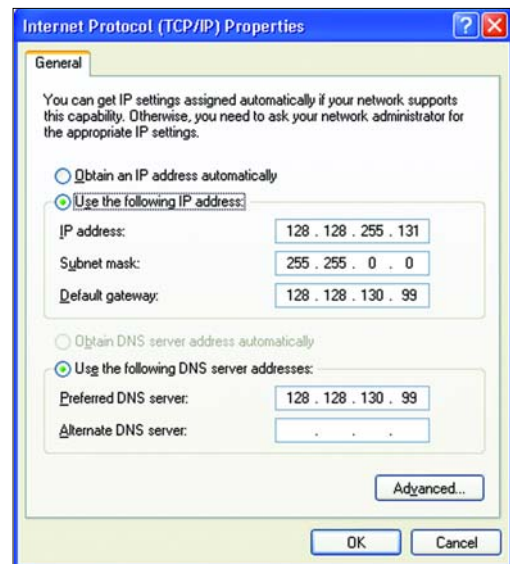
 sos@jasubhai.com

E-mail us your computing problems, and we may answer them here! Since we get more mails per day than we can handle, it may take some time for your query to be answered. Rest assured, we are listening!

Download and use Jabber (www.jabber.org)—an open-source IM client—to chat with your friends over the LAN. Run Jabber as the server on one of the machines and the rest can then join the chat session. Other simpler clients are LANMessage Pro (0.28 MB), Network Chat 1.30 (9.32 MB), Network Assistant 3.2 (1.29 MB), etc. Download them from www.softpedia.com.

PC Access Via The Internet

Q I have a P III 800 MHz and a Mercury LAN card running Windows 98SE. I cannot add my friend's computer in 'Network Neighbourhood'. We both use Iquara's broadband Internet connection. Is there any way I can add him via the Internet?



This is where you can obtain the IP address from

Also, the system never gets past the "Windows is shutting down" message when I shut it via the OS. It's been a long time since it said that "It's now safe to turn off your computer"! Help needed. Desperately!

Tejas Subramaniam

A Ping the IP address of your friend's computer. Click on Start > Run, type 'command' and click OK. At the command prompt, type `ping 'XX.XX.XX.XX'`, (where XX.XX.XX.XX is your friend's IP address) and press [Enter].

If you receive a reply from his address, then you can access his computer. All he needs to do is share his folder or drive and you can do the same. If you cannot access your friend's computer in this manner, then use an FTP server such as BulletProof Server (www.bpfptserver.com). If access is still not possible, then probably you are on a separate network and you will need to contact your ISP.

As for the improper shutdown in Windows 98, you will need to download and install its shutdown patch from http://www.microsoft.com/windows98/downloads/contents/WURecommended/S_WUFeatured/Win98SE/Default.asp. ☒